MAHJ

Launch Posts — Ready-to-share content

`https://welcome2mahj.com`

MAHJ Launch Posts

Attention-grabbing posts for sharing MAHJ in different communities.

Current URL: https://welcome2mahj.com

Reddit — r/Mahjong

Title options (pick whichever hits hardest):

> *- The American Mahjong learning app I wish existed when I started*

> *- I was so lost at my first mahj game. So I built the app I wish I'd had.*

> *- Finally — an American Mahjong tutorial that doesn't assume you already know the game*

Body:

My first American Mahjong game was a disaster. I couldn't read the card. I didn't know what "Charleston" meant. I passed a Joker (yes — the thing you're never supposed to do). The women at the table were wonderful, but I left feeling like I'd wasted everyone's time.

I wanted to come back. I just didn't know how to study for it.

So I built **MAHJ** — the tool I wish I'd had before that first game.

What's in it:

🀄 **14 interactive lessons** — Not walls of text. You actually *do* things: identify tiles under a timer, practice the Charleston with feedback, decide what to discard in real scenarios.

🎮 **A full practice game** — Play against 3 smart bots. Real Charleston. Pick a target hand. Draw, call, swap jokers, declare Mahjong. They'll call your discards if you feed them. You'll learn faster in one practice round than reading rules for an hour.

📄 **A printable cheat sheet** — Two pages, designed for your pocket at game night. Your turn flow, calling rules, joker rules, the card notation key, strategy, payouts. Print it, fold it, bring it.

🔢 **A scoring calculator** — Stop arguing about payouts. Enter the hand value, pick the win type, get the answer.

📖 **90+ term glossary** — Searchable. "What's a quint again?" — answer in two seconds.

Important: Not affiliated with NMJL. The practice hands are original patterns that represent the real card's categories (2468, Consecutive Run, Like Numbers, 369, Winds & Dragons, Singles & Pairs, Quints, etc). You still need the real NMJL card for official play — I'm not replacing it, I'm helping you understand it.

👉 **https://welcome2mahj.com**

Works on phones, tablets, computers. No signup. Installable as a PWA on iPhone (Safari → Share → Add to Home Screen).

I'd love feedback — especially from experienced players who can catch anything I got wrong, and from beginners who can tell me where they got confused. This is early, and I'm actively improving it.

Facebook — Mahj Groups

Short version (comments, short posts):

I built something for American Mahjong beginners that I wish I'd had when I started. 🀄

MAHJ is a learning app with 14 lessons, a practice game against bots, and a printable cheat sheet you can bring to your first game night. It covers everything — Charleston, calling, jokers, strategy, scoring, etiquette.

If you know someone learning (or you're learning yourself), give it a try: 👉 https://welcome2mahj.com

(Not affiliated with NMJL — you still need the official card.)

Longer version (standalone posts):

"Wait, can you explain the Charleston again?"

I've heard this at every beginner game I've been to. And honestly? I asked it myself more times than I want to admit.

American Mahjong is one of the best games in the world, but it's HARD to learn. The card looks like a secret code. Nobody quite agrees on what to pass. You're terrified of passing a Joker by accident.

So I built **MAHJ** — a learning app that takes you from "what's a bam?" to "I can play my first real game" without embarrassing yourself.

Here's what's inside: 🀄

📚 14 interactive lessons covering everything — tiles, setup, Charleston, calling, jokers, strategy, defense, scoring, etiquette, common mistakes 🎮 A full practice game against 3 bots with a real Charleston and hand-selection flow 📄 A printable two-page cheat sheet to bring to your first game night 🔢 A scoring calculator (finally, no more arguments about payouts) 📖 A searchable glossary of 90+ mahj terms

It's designed to be *approachable* — short lessons, instant feedback, and no condescension. You can work through it at your own pace.

Important note: This is NOT affiliated with the National Mah Jongg League, and it doesn't reproduce the card. The practice hands are original examples of the real categories. You still need to buy the official NMJL card for actual games — this just helps you learn how to use it.

👉 **https://welcome2mahj.com**

If you know someone who's trying to learn, or you're learning yourself, please share it! And if you're an experienced player who spots something I should fix, please tell me — I want this to be right.

Twitter / X

Post 1 — Hook:

> *My first American Mahjong game was a disaster.*

>

> *I passed a Joker in the Charleston. (You never pass a Joker.)*

>

> *So I built the learning tool I wish I'd had. No signup. No ads.*

>

> 👉 *https://welcome2mahj.com*

Post 2 — The problem:

> *American Mahjong has one of the steepest learning curves in gaming:*

>

> *— A cryptic card that looks like code*

> *— A 7-pass tile-trading ritual*

> *— Specific rules about jokers, calling, scoring*

>

> *I built a tool that walks you through all of it. No signup. No ads.*

>

> *https://welcome2mahj.com*

Post 3 — The cheat sheet:

> *Bringing someone to their first American Mahjong game night?*

>

> *This printable cheat sheet has everything they need on two pages: turn flow, calling, jokers, card notation, strategy, payouts.*

>

> *Print it. Bring it. Survive.*

>

> 🀄 *https://welcome2mahj.com/cheatsheet*

Post 4 — Practice game:

> *Most mahj tutorials tell you what the rules are.*

>

> *MAHJ makes you play.*

>

> *Full Charleston. Pick a target hand. Play against 3 smart bots that call your discards and pursue real hand patterns. You'll learn more in one practice round than reading for an hour.*

>

> *https://welcome2mahj.com*

LinkedIn

The product I wish existed when I started learning American Mahjong

Three months ago, I sat down to my first American Mahjong game. I knew the tiles, sort of. I knew the basic idea. What I didn't know was almost everything else — and within minutes, it was painfully obvious.

American Mahjong has an unusually steep learning curve. There's a yearly card from the National Mah Jongg League that lists every legal winning hand — but the notation is cryptic, the categories are unintuitive, and the rules around jokers, calling, and scoring are specific enough that generic "mahjong" tutorials actively confuse you.

Most online resources assume you already know the basics. The good ones are expensive classes. The free ones are walls of text.

So I built **MAHJ** — an interactive, beginner-first learning tool for American Mahjong.

What's inside:

- 14 progressive lessons covering tiles, setup, the Charleston, calling, jokers, strategy, defense, scoring, and etiquette
- An interactive practice game against AI opponents that pursue real hand patterns
- A printable two-page cheat sheet designed for someone sitting at their first real game
- A scoring calculator and a searchable glossary of 90+ terms

Technical stack: Next.js 16, React 19, TypeScript, Tailwind CSS 4. Pattern-matching engine built from scratch (can't reproduce NMJL card hands due to copyright, so the practice library uses 24 original patterns representing the real card's categories). Deployed on Vercel, iOS wrapper via Capacitor.

What surprised me: The hardest part wasn't the game logic — it was making sure the teaching content was accurate *and* accessible. Several full audits caught places where I'd accidentally drifted into generic mahjong territory. American Mahjong has rules that diverge significantly from Chinese/Japanese variants, and getting them exactly right took more care than I expected.

If you know someone who plays, or who's trying to learn, I'd love for them to try it.

👉 https://welcome2mahj.com

Feedback welcome — especially from anyone who teaches mahj or runs a club.

Nextdoor / Local Community

For anyone learning American Mahjong — or who knows someone who is

I made a learning app for American Mahjong and I wanted to share it with neighbors who might find it useful.

If you've ever been curious about joining a mahj group but felt intimidated by the card, the Charleston, or all the rules around jokers and calling — **MAHJ** walks you through everything from the beginning. It has interactive lessons, a practice game against bots, and a printable cheat sheet to bring to your first game night.

👉 https://welcome2mahj.com

Please feel free to share with anyone in your mahj group or club who might want it. No signup required.

(Not affiliated with the National Mah Jongg League — you'll still need the official card to play real games.)

Instagram Caption

I was completely lost at my first American Mahjong game.

So I built the app I wish someone had handed me before I sat down at that table.

MAHJ walks you from "what are all these tiles?" to playing with confidence:

✨ 14 bite-sized interactive lessons 🎮 Practice game against smart bots 📄 A printable cheat sheet you can bring to game night 🔢 Scoring calculator 📖 90+ term glossary

No ads. No accounts. No data tracking. Just learn at your own pace.

Link in bio 🀄

#americanmahjong #mahjong #mahjongg #nmjl #mahj #gamenight #learnmahjong #mahjonglife #charleston #mahjongtiles #learnsomethingnew #tilegame #boardgames #tabletop

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Email to Friends / Family

Subject: I built a thing — American Mahjong learning app

Hi [name],

Remember how overwhelming mahj was when you first tried it? [Or: I know you've wanted to learn American Mahjong...]

I built something that might help. It's called **MAHJ** — a web app that walks beginners through everything from identifying tiles to playing their first game. It has:

- 14 interactive lessons (the tiles, the Charleston, calling, jokers, strategy, scoring)
- A practice game against bots so you can play a full round before a real one
- A printable cheat sheet to bring to your first game night

It's designed for absolute beginners — no assumed knowledge, no condescension, just a step-by-step path from "I have no idea what this is" to "I can sit down at a table."

👉 https://welcome2mahj.com

Works on your phone, tablet, or computer. No account needed.

If you try it, I'd love to hear what you think — especially anything that's confusing or unclear. Your feedback would mean a lot.

[Your name]

Mahj Club / Teacher Outreach Email

Subject: Learning tool for your American Mahjong beginners

Hello,

I'm reaching out because you teach or run a group for American Mahjong players, and I built something that might help with your beginners.

MAHJ is an interactive web app designed to take absolute beginners from zero to their first game. No signup required. It covers:

- Tile recognition (all 152 tiles, identified by sight and sound)
- Setup, wall building, and dealing
- The Charleston — with an interactive simulator that rates their passes
- Calling rules (pung/kong/quint/mahjong) and joker mechanics
- Hand strategy and reading the card
- Defense and reading the table
- Table etiquette and common mistakes (Article 67, misnamed discards, etc.)
- Scoring and payout calculation

It's designed for self-study between lessons, or as a companion to in-person teaching. Students can work through it at their own pace, practice against AI bots before real games, and print a two-page cheat sheet to bring to their first game night.

Important notes for compliance: MAHJ is not affiliated with NMJL and doesn't reproduce the card. The practice hand patterns are original examples of the real categories (2468, Consecutive Run, Like Numbers, 369, Winds & Dragons, etc.). Students still need the official NMJL card for actual play — the app explicitly directs them to purchase it.

If you think this could help your students, please share it with them. I'd also deeply appreciate any feedback from you as an experienced teacher — what's missing, what's unclear, what I got wrong.

👉 https://welcome2mahj.com

Thank you for keeping American Mahjong alive and welcoming new players to the table.

Best, [Your name] info@welcome2mahj.com

Quick Tips for Sharing

General:

- **Lead with a hook, not a pitch.** "My first game was a disaster" > "Announcing MAHJ" — every time.
- **Be specific.** "14 lessons, 3 bots, printable cheat sheet" beats "lots of features."

- **Ask for feedback.** People respond better to "I need help improving this" than "check out my app."

Reddit:

- Post on weekday afternoons (US time) for best visibility
- Respond to every comment quickly — mods notice engagement
- Don't crosspost verbatim — adapt for each sub

Facebook:

- Read group rules first — some ban self-promotion
- Replying in existing "How did you learn?" threads often works better than a standalone post
- Tag relevant friends who you know are learning

Twitter:

- Post the hook thread, then pin it
- Reply to anyone asking about mahj in general
- Use hashtags sparingly — 1-2 per post

For all platforms:

- Don't mass-post the same text — algorithms flag it as spam
- Respond to every reply, even "cool!" — engagement drives reach
- If someone says "I got confused at X" — THANK them and ask follow-ups. That's gold.
- Don't apologize for promoting your work. You made something useful.